

# Industry News

## Semiconductor and EDA forecasts for 2010

In 2010 and beyond, the challenges are big for semiconductor and electronic design automation (EDA) industries, but so are the opportunities. Jaswinder Ahuja, corporate vice president and managing director, Cadence Design Systems (India), feels that EDA providers and semiconductor companies must collaborate to reduce the escalating cost of high-quality design and remove productivity bottlenecks, and work together to bring the semiconductor industry out of the doldrums.

In the EDA industry, providers must not only help customers reduce design and verification costs and solve technology problems but also help them differentiate themselves from competitors, and collaborate with partners on a worldwide basis. To do this, the EDA industry must focus on integrated solutions and close partnerships rather than simply selling point tools.

EDA will have to make the verification process cost-effective and focus not only on design but also on IP integration so that design predictability can be ensured for customers at optimal costs. Design-for-manufacturing technologies, including extremely accurate modeling solutions for both mask-making and manufacturing to avoid expensive silicon re-spins, should be another focus area.

The demand for new functionality is driving both the importance and complexity increase in mixed-signal and radio frequency designs.

As customers face significant cost pressure, outsourcing certain elements of a production-grade design environment can address certain customer needs for reduced cost and risk. As a result, software as a service will continue to gain traction in 2010.

## Singh is now CMD of MTNL

Kuldip Singh has been appointed as the new chairman and managing director (acting) of Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Ltd (MTNL). He was formerly a director (technical) with the state-run telecom operator.

In a surprise move, former chairman and managing director R.S.P. Sinha had resigned from his post earlier. The reasons behind the resignation were not known. Sinha was 18 months away from retirement.

## LG reshuffles top management

LG Electronics India has announced changes and amendments to its top management profile. Dr Y.V. Vema has been elevated to the position of chief operating officer (COO), LG India.

Further top management changes at LG Electronics India include the shifting of V. Ramchandran (formerly director of marketing) to the level of head-strategy. Amitabh Tiwari (formerly business head of home entertainment) has been elevated as the head of sales. Rohit Pandit who brings with him over 16 years of experience in consumer durable industry has been elevated as the business head for

LG Home Entertainment.

## Kohli to head Bharti's global business unit

Bharti Airtel has created an International Business Group that will be responsible for expanding the company's operations beyond India and South Asia region. Manoj Kohli, who is currently the CEO (India and South Asia) and joint MD of the company, will head the International Business Group as CEO (International) and joint MD and will continue to be a member of the Bharti Airtel board.

Sanjay Kapoor, currently deputy CEO of the company, will be elevated to the position of CEO (India and South Asia), Bharti Airtel.

## Das joins EMC India as COO

Subroto Das has been appointed as chief operating officer of EMC India and SAARC region. He will be responsible for driving sales in the region and work towards maximising productivity and coverage across enterprise and commercial markets. Das will report to Manoj Chugh, president, EMC India and SAARC.

## Mobile number portability likely by March end

Extending the timeline for mobile number portability (MNP) implementation, the government has now decided to implement it in whole of the country in one go by 31st March this year. Earlier, in the first phase, the MNP service was likely to be implemented in metro and category 'A' service areas. It shall allow subscribers to retain their existing telephone number when they switch from one access service provider to another, irrespective of mobile technology or from one technology to another of the same or any other access service provider within the same service area.

The country has been divided into

two zones and licences have been issued to one MNP operator in each zone for MNP implementation.

## PM launches national solar mission

Prime Minister Dr Manmohan Singh has launched an ambitious solar energy mission called *Solar India*. The mission aims to generate 20,000 MW of solar power by 2022 – the end of the 13th Five Year Plan period.

"Technological innovation will be a key factor in ensuring the success of this mission. We will need to find ways of reducing the space intensity of current solar applications, including through the use of nano-technology. Cost-effective and convenient